



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	12 th September 2022	Time of Incident:	14:50pm
Region / Directorate:	MWG RMO	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury/Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	28329
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Contractor Light Vehicle Conducts U-Turn into Path of Oncoming Member of Public Vehicle
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Executive Summary:

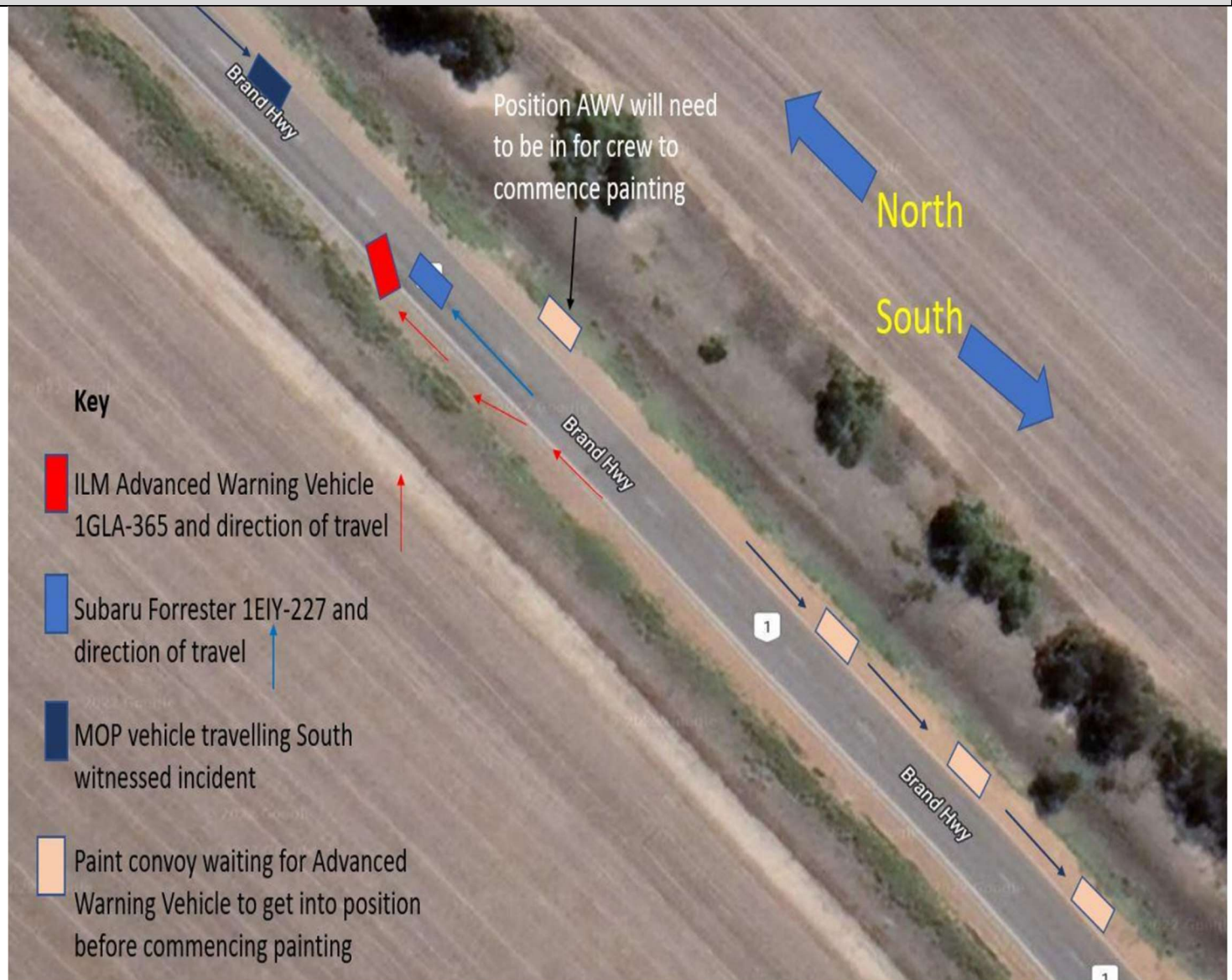
On the 12/09/2022 a line marking crew were painting edge lines on a highway which involves a paint truck and various vehicles positioned on the left-hand edge of the road, painting the line. The crew were utilising an Advanced Warning Vehicle (AWV) to warn oncoming traffic that there are work vehicles ahead.

The crew were positioned facing Southbound on the left-hand edge of a highway preparing to restart works after returning from refilling the paint truck. The AWV was in the wrong position in the convoy and the convoy could not move forward as they were at the start of the paint run. This meant the AWV had to move further back down the road had to move further back down the road so they could be positioned at 300m – 500m behind the other work vehicles as per traffic management requirements.

The operator of the AWV pulled out of the convoy and completed a U-turn to head North so they could reposition correctly. Once reaching the required distance the operator pulled to the left-hand verge of the road and at approximately 2:50 PM commenced a second U-Turn to cross back over the highway to face Southbound. During this U-Turn manoeuvre the AWV crossed into the path of an oncoming Northbound Member of Public (MOP) vehicle.

The front left-hand side of the Northbound MOP vehicle contacted the right-hand side front guard and door of the AWV causing both vehicles to travel East across the road and come to a stop. Both drivers exited their respective vehicles, with only minor muscle pain sustained by the AWV operator.

Incident Photos:



Position of vehicles at the time of the incident



Damage to AWV and MOP Vehicle

Contributing Factors:	
• AWW was in the incorrect position when the convoy pulled up. Convoy to travel in order of work positioning not identified. • Risk management processes did not consider a Vehicle Movement Plan (VMP) for the operation. • Process for completing U-Turn not in place (no VMP). • Spotters and/or two-way communication not used. • Width of the shoulder is not wide enough for a light vehicle to be able to position itself to be able to see both lanes of traffic clearly. • Driver of AWW failed to identify oncoming traffic. • Restricted vision with Variable Message Board (VMB) on back of AWW. • Contractor purchasing process does not look at the options available for safety devices.	
Corrective Actions:	
• Procedure (Vehicle Movement Plan) for completing U-turns to be developed, implemented, and communicated. This will detail how and when a U-Turn can be completed, including use of spotters and two-way communication. It will also call for side roads to be used if they are close enough and verge edges to be wide enough for vehicles to position themselves perpendicular to the road. • When travelling to site vehicle convoy is to travel in the order, they are to commence work in, this will be communicated in a Vehicle Movement Plan. • Install rear-facing cameras on vehicles with restricted vision. • Review the work planning process to see if there is an opportunity to pre-plan potential turn around points for addressing in the VMP. • Update SWMS and risk assessment to identify and mitigate the risks of vehicles doing a U-turn. • Review purchasing process to look at options for built in safety devices/technology.	
Additional Issues/Learnings:	
• It is vital that vehicle operators ensure that the road is clear when accessing the live lane whether they are completing a U-Turn or any other manoeuvre that has their vehicle entering the road. • Ensuring the convoy travels in their respective order to site will help remove the need for repositioning of vehicles.	
 Critical Risk: This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to Vehicles and Driving	
Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations